Density	1.25 g/cm^3
Reaction	Causes less damage with acid
To flame	Burns with a sputtering flame
Sunlight	Increased exposures will breakdown the fibres
Insects	Destroyed by carpet beetles
Drying	Quick and good
Dyeing	Good absorption for acid and basic dyes

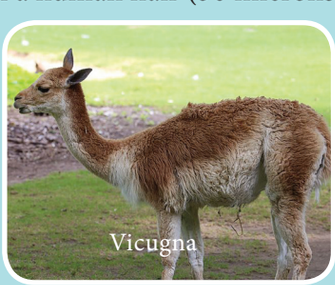
2.3.4 Common Uses of Silk

- Clothing (Scarfs, Silk Sari, Dothi, Towel, Dress Materials).
- Household textiles (Bed Spread, Wall Hangers, Table Cloths).
- Medical Textiles (Suture Threads).

DO YOU KNOW?

Which is the most Expensive Fiber in the World?

The most expensive fiber in the world comes from the Vicuna which is a type of camel and boasts the softest and rarest fiber in the world which is a result of its fineness. It is the finest fiber which can be spun measuring only 12 microns which is much thinner than a human hair (50 microns).



Vicugna

2.4 WOOL

- Wool is one of the oldest fibres used for protection from cold climate.
- In Tamil wool is called as KAMBULI. The hair of sheep (Figure 2.10), camel and rabbit are also used as wool fibres. They were woven as garments and used. Even during early days, woolen clothes were worn by the people.



Figure 2.10 Sheep Source for Wool

- The quality of wool depends upon the type of animal, its health, food and climatic conditions and place of breeding.

Principle Origin	Natural
Generic Name	Animal Hair
Chemical Type	Protein
Common Name	Wool

2.4.1 Processing of Wool

The best wool (Figure 2.11) can be obtained from animals which are free from diseases and chemicals and fed with nutritional diet. Wool can be taken from sheep's by two methods- namely wool shearing from live animals or pulled off from the skin

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